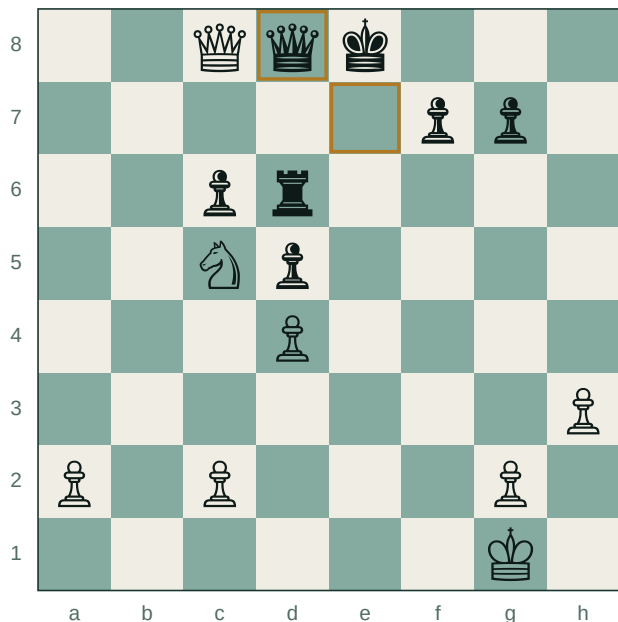


# Calculated sacrifices: White, move 35

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 34...Qd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**35. Nb7 Qxc8 36. Nxd6+ Kd7 37. Nxc8**

**35.Nb7** The knight moves from c5 to b7. From b7 it attacks queen on d8 and rook on d6. Recorded reply: **35...Qxc8**.

**36.Nxd6+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on e8 and queen on c8. Recorded reply: **36...Kd7**.

**37.Nxc8** The knight captures the queen on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: queen on d8.